

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

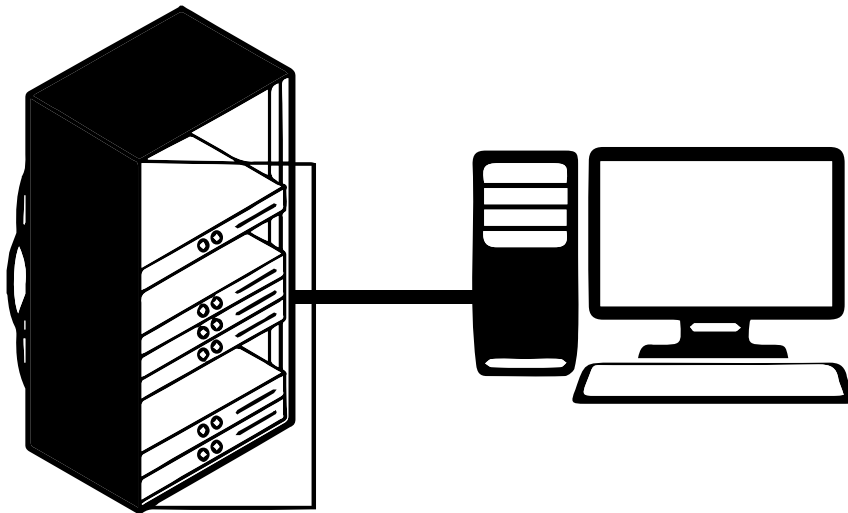
## CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



### Let's Start!

#### Understanding Information Systems



#### Learning Outcome:

Understand information about relational database management system in spoken or written texts.

#### Ask your partner:

- Why do you think it is important for an organization to access and control data?
- Do you think it is necessary to classify and analyze data? Why?

#### Can Do Statements:

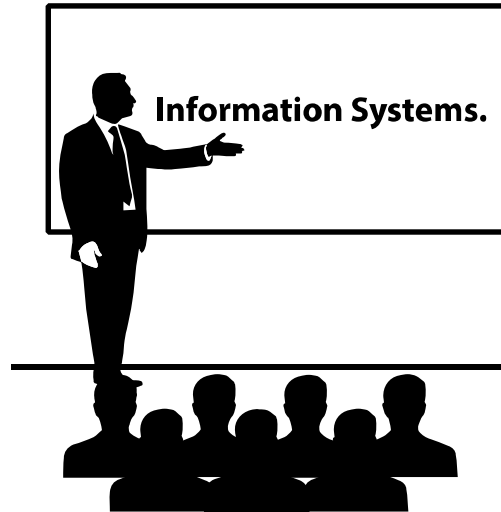
- I can explain what an information system is.
- I can identify different categories of information systems.
- I can talk about types of information systems based on hierarchy.





## Let's Explore!

Let me define and categorize information systems...



*Instructions: Read the text below.*

Nowadays and because of the rapid changes of technology, organizations need to find new ways of storing, organizing, and analyzing information. Many researchers in the business environment have shown that sales and the relationship with potential customers can improve if companies use information systems for classifying data. How can we define an information system? Let's say it is a group of software tools aimed to access and control data. Databases, computer programs, and user interfaces are the main components of an information system. Data warehouses, expert systems, and office automation are examples of these systems. For instance, in office automation, information is stored and controlled in order to complete tasks. Data warehouses, on the other hand, are used for analyzing data.

As you may know, analyzing information is vital for companies to find new strategies that can cope with the demanding market. This way, information systems are used by companies to make conscious decisions and turn raw and disorganized information into valuable opportunities for them. Due to the large amounts of information they have to deal with, big companies have decided to create departments that focus on information systems that fit their corporate needs.

What I want you to notice here is that getting to know how information systems work can lead to a better use of technological advances within the business environment. If we want to thrive, keeping up with the technological trends is a good idea. Now, information systems are classified with a classic model called the Pyramid Model. It's a four-level pyramid system based on the hierarchy in an organization. If we use a top-down image of the pyramid, the hierarchy goes like this: executives are placed on top, followed by senior managers, middle managers and, on the bottom, workers. Hopefully, you'll find this information useful to carry out your duties.





## Let's Practice!

Let's go over data and information systems.

*Instructions: Circle the correct option to complete the sentences.*

1. Information (is / are) stored and controlled in office automation.
2. Information systems are (to use / used) in decision-making.
3. The effect of information systems on the business environment (are / is) studied by researchers.
4. Different software tools are (needs / needed) to build an information system.
5. Information is (stored / storing) in order to complete tasks.



## Let's Practice!

Information systems are essential for companies.

*Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing word(s) in the blank. Use: Understanding that, Keeping up with, Creating a department, Being aware of the impact, Getting to know how.*

1. \_\_\_\_\_ the advances of information systems comes in handy for defining new sale strategies.
2. \_\_\_\_\_ information systems, such as data warehouses, are helpful for analyzing data is vital in our business.
3. \_\_\_\_\_ the impact that information systems have on the production processes of a company can lead to many benefits.
4. \_\_\_\_\_ the pyramid method works is important for understanding the function of information systems.
5. \_\_\_\_\_ that focuses on information systems is mandatory for companies that work with large amounts of information.



## Extension Activity

Information systems? Are they really useful?

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Look for more information on information systems and their impact on the business environment.
- Summarize the most important information you found.
- Write a brochure in which you explain the perks of using an information system in a company.
- Include the grammar topics of the lesson.
- Share your brochure with a partner.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I look for more information about information systems applied to the business environment.
- I summarize the most important information of each source.
- I create a brochure in order to explain the advantages of using an information system in a company.
- I include the grammar I learned in this lesson and share my work with a partner.

☐ ☐
☐ ☐
☐ ☐
☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **fit** (verb): to be suitable and appropriate  
e.g. Big companies have decided to create their own departments for focusing on information systems that fit their corporate needs.
- **trend** (noun): tendency; course or fashion behavior  
e.g. If we want to thrive, keeping up with the technological trends is a good idea.
- **carry out** (phrasal verb): to develop or do something  
e.g. Hopefully, you'll find this information useful to carry out your duties.
- **raw** (adjective): that has not been processed  
e.g. They turn raw and disorganized information into valuable opportunities for a company.
- **within** (preposition): inside  
e.g. Getting to know how information systems work can lead to a better use of technological advances within the business environment.



## Learning Points

### Simple Present Passive in Affirmative Statements

In grammar, the **voice** of a verb refers to the connection between the action that a verb indicates and the subject and object of the same sentence. We use **passive voice** when the object of the sentence takes the place of the subject. Let's see how it works for **affirmative sentences** in **simple present tense**.

Take a look at the following example:

*Companies use information systems.*

Let's divide the sentence into its components: *Companies* (**subject or doer**) *use* (**action**) *information systems* (**object**).

The relationship between the elements within this sentence indicate that the voice is active (**active voice**) because the subject is the doer of the action and the object somehow receives the action.

Now, what happens if we change the order of the elements? Let's find out:

*Information systems **are used by** companies.*

In this case, the object takes the place of the doer. Why do we do that? The **passive voice** is a way of giving importance to the object. It can be used when we do not know who the doer of an action is or when we simply want to avoid mentioning it.

Notice that in the last example, we use the preposition **by** to introduce the doer (which is now a secondary element in the sentence). This is not mandatory, you can avoid mentioning the doer, but whenever you want to include it, you need to use that preposition.

The grammatical structure needed in this case is the following:

Object + **verb to be in present + verb (action) in past participle** + preposition by + doer

Let me give you another example:





## Learning Points

| Voice          | Subject            | Verb    | Object            |
|----------------|--------------------|---------|-------------------|
| Active voice:  | Peter              | uses    | a data warehouse. |
| Passive voice: | The data warehouse | is used | by Peter.         |

### Examples

- *Information is stored and controlled in order to complete tasks.*
- *Data warehouses, on the other hand, are used for analyzing data.*
- *Information systems are used by companies to make conscious decisions.*
- *Information systems are classified with a classic model called the Pyramid Model.*
- *Executives are placed on top..*



## Learning Points

### Types of Information Systems Based on Hierarchy

Information systems are vital for storing and analyzing large amounts of information. Nowadays, these systems are popular because they help companies to get benefits from the analysis of information that was not taken into account before.

An information system is a group of tools (hardware and software) that helps you organize and analyze data. There is a classic method, used since the 1980s, to classify the types of information systems. This method is called the pyramid method. It refers to four levels in which the hierarchy of an organization is described. This is a bottom-up description of the pyramid:

**Workers :** Transaction processing systems

**Mid-managers :** Management information systems

**Senior managers:** Decision support systems

**Executives:** Executive information systems

